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Chapter 3

Enquiries



Forecast Enquiries Introduction

You use the enquiry to selectively view forecasts. You can enquire on Forecasts for a specific item, or a group of items within a Forecasting Model.



Note: Forecasts for the group are generated by the Period-end run using Sales History quantities stored for the group. Forecasting treats the group as just another set of figures to be evaluated.

The Forecast Enquiry displays the last 3 years sales demand figures, together with the forecasts for the next 12 or 13 periods.

The number of periods displayed, either 12 or 13, depends on how you have configured the current company profile.

You can also see the code for the Forecast Method selected together with the calculated forecast error.

You can change the Forecast Method code to one of the other seven. This results in the forecast quantities being recalculated and displayed.

No update is performed, this is purely a What if? facility allowing the user to see the impact of different forecasting methods.

A Bar Chart is also available for displaying these quantities pictorially.

Forecast Enquiry



1/FCE

You use this enquiry to display sales history and current forecasts for a selected item, or group of items within a Forecasting Model. The last 3 years demand history and next 12 or 13 periods forecasts are shown.

You can also view these quantities in a Bar Chart.

Forecast Enquiry Selection Screen



Select Forecast Enquiry.

Use this screen to select the Forecasting Model and the item, or group of items, to enquire on.

FC038	Z1 - Demonstration Company	USER SP1	6/09/94 17:36:25
Forecast Enquiry - Select			
Model.....?	C1	Midlands DRP Centre	
Group.....?	3	Sun Protection	
Item.....?	5001	Suncream Factor 4 225ml	
F3=Exit F4=Prompt			

Fields:

Model

Enter the Forecasting Model code for the enquiry.

Group

Enter a Group code.

Item

Or enter an Item code. The item must have a profile record for this group within the application.

If you enter a group, and leave the item field blank, the Details screen is displayed for this Group of items. If you enter both codes the Details screen is displayed for the item.



Press **Enter** to display the Forecast Enquiry Details screen.

Forecast Enquiry Details Screen



To display this screen, select your enquiry criteria on the Forecast Enquiry Selection screen and press **Enter**.

This screen displays the sales history and forecasted quantities for the selected item, or group of items within the selected Forecasting Model.

The last three years demand history and next 12 or 13 periods forecasts are displayed.

FC038	Z1 - Demonstration Company	USER SP1	6/09/94 17:36:36		
Forecast Enquiry - Details					
Model.. C1	Group..... 3	Item... 5001	Forecast Code...?.. B		
Suncream Factor 4 225ml		Error (%)....	26.06		
Period	91/92	92/93	93/94	94/95	Mask
9	25	30	210	298	1.00
10	40	45	225	305	1.00
11	55	60	240	311	1.00
12	70	75	255	317	1.00
13	85	90	270	322	1.00
1	100	105	285	326	1.00
2	115	120	300	329	1.00
3	130	135	315	331	1.00
4	145	150	330	332	1.00
5	160	165	345	332	1.00
6	175	180	360	331	1.00
7	180	200	400	329	1.00
8	15	195	345	324	1.00
***	1295	1550	3880	4187	
F3=Exit F4=Prompt F12=Previous F15=Text F18=Graph					

Fields:

Model

This is the forecasting model selected on the Forecast Enquiries Detail screen.

Group

This the group selected on the Forecast Enquiries Detail screen.

Item

This is the item selected on the Forecast Enquiries Detail screen.

Description

This field is not named on the screen, and contains a description for the selected item, or group of items.

Forecast Code

The selected forecast method code.

You can overtype the displayed code with a different code, if you enter *, you can change the quantity fields for the forecasts. Press **Enter** to display the details for the specified Forecast Code.



Tip: This presents a What if? situation and displays the impact of using different forecast methods. No data is changed or files updated, this can only be done through the Forecast Manipulation option.

If the Forecast Code is changed, the forecasts are immediately recalculated using the appropriate formula for this method. The forecast error is also recalculated.



*Note: * indicates a manually entered forecast.*

Locked In Forecast

The Forecast Method locked into for this item or group. If specified, this is the one used in the Period-end Run for generating forecasts. This field is only displayed when you have specified a locked into forecast.

Error %

The percentage error calculated for this Forecast Method.



Note: The mechanics of this calculation are explained in the Applying Forecasting Techniques section at the beginning of Processing..



Note: In the main body of the screen, quantities are shown for the last three years' demand history and the next 12 or 13 periods' forecasts. The periods are retrieved from the descriptions on the Company Profile

The forecast quantities shown are calculated before the Marketing Masks are applied, that is the initial forecasts.

The Marketing Masks in the final column are those for the selected item or group, as specified on the profile record for the selected Model.

If the masks for an item are all zero, the masks for the group are used. If the group masks are all zero, then all 12 are defaulted to a factor of 1.



Note: The Forecast Code is normally selected as the best method for forecasting this item, or group of items. However, it may have been changed using the Forecast Manipulation option.

Functions:

F15

Text. Use this to maintain text for this group or particular item

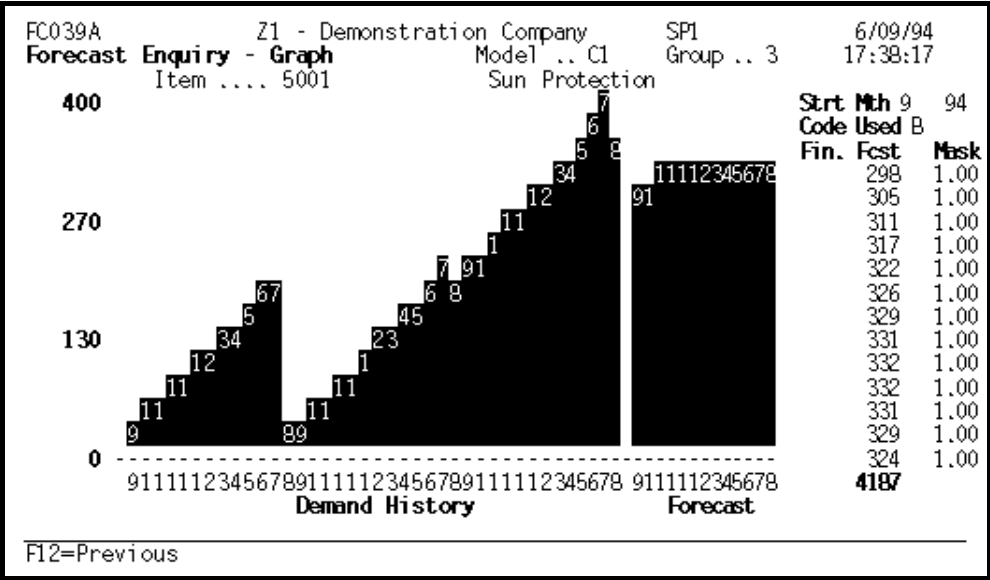
F18

Graph. Select this to display the graph screen.

Forecast Enquiry Graph Screen (F18)

 Select **F18=Graph** to display this screen.

This screen displays the final forecasts, for the selected Group or Item, as a Bar Chart. This chart can be modified from the previous screen, or Forecast Manipulation.



Fields:

Model

This is the forecast model entered on the selection screen.

Group

This is the group entered on the selection screen.

Item

This is the item entered on the selection screen.

Strt Mth

The first month for the forecasts.

Code Used

The Forecast Method used for generating the forecasts.

Fin Fcst

The final forecast quantities for the next 12 or 13 periods, that is after the corresponding factor from the Marketing Mask has been multiplied on top of the originally calculated forecast.

Mask

The corresponding Marketing Mask factors are shown for the next 12 or 13 periods, unless the item or group is manually forecast in which case masks are not applied.

The graph itself splits into two. The left-hand side shows the sales history, and the right shows the forecast quantities.

The scale on the Y axis is calculated so that the highest peak just fits on the screen.



Note: The quantities used for the forecasts in the graph are the final forecasts shown down the right-hand side of the screen.



Press **Enter** to return to the menu.